



Product Documentation

Installation, Configuration, Administration and User Guide

Product	Attendr
Version	1.0.1
Platform	Windows
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Self-hosted staff presence software

Free forever for up to 30 active users | Unlimited users with a one-time licence

Document control

Purpose

This guide covers the current Windows release of Attendr v1.0.1: installation, first-time setup, everyday use, administration, integrations, licensing, backup and troubleshooting. It is written for both end users and system administrators.

Item	Detail
Product	Attendr
Release	v1.0.1
Deployment model	Self-hosted / on-premise
Primary platform	Windows 10, Windows 11, Windows Server 2016+
Default application port	TCP 3000
Database	SQLite, stored locally in the Attendr data folder
Support site	https://attendr.com.au

Licensing summary

- Attendr is free forever for up to 30 active non-system users.
- No licence key is required while the instance remains within the free-user allowance.
- A paid instance-bound licence unlocks unlimited users.
- The current paid licence does not expire.
- The application remains usable on the free plan; the licence is only required to add user 31 and above.

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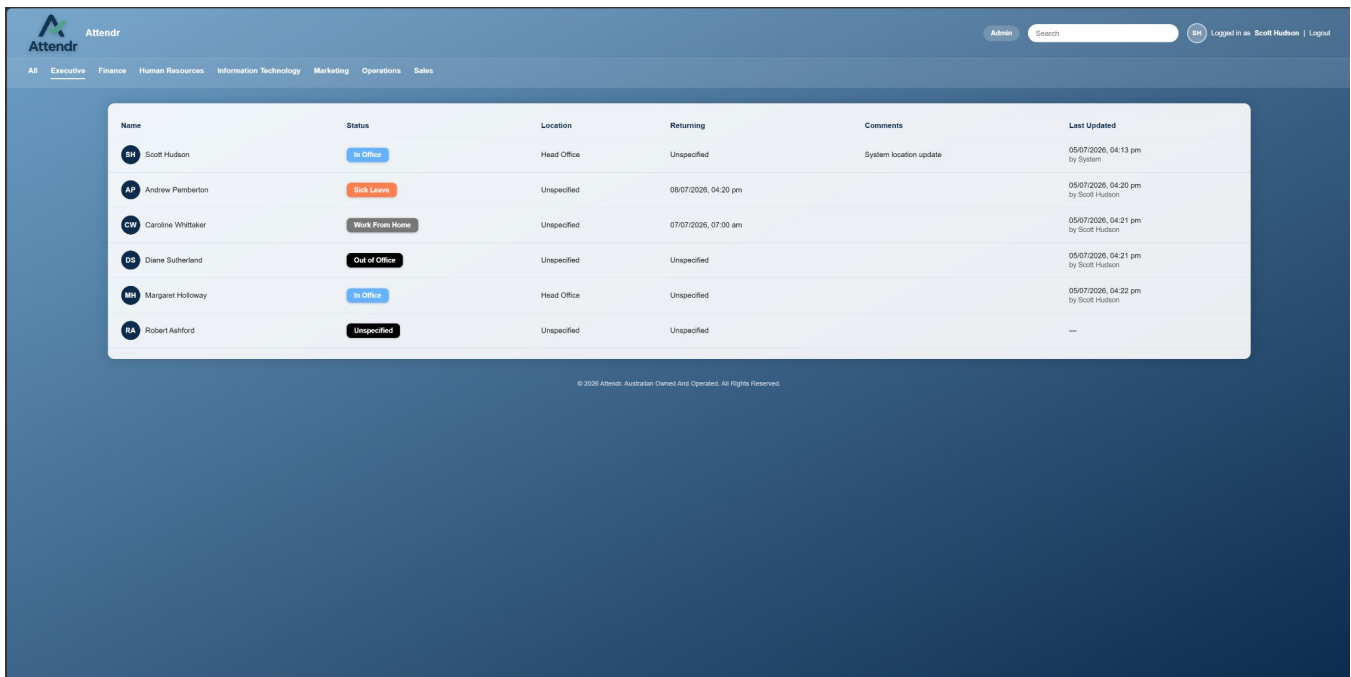
1. Attendr overview

Attendr is a self-hosted staff presence and in/out board application. It provides a central view of staff availability, status, current location, expected return time and optional comments. The application is designed to run on an organisation's own Windows PC or server, with the application and data kept under the organisation's control.

Core capabilities

- Real-time staff presence board with department filtering.
- Custom statuses with configurable colours and sort order.
- Locations, including CIDR-based automatic location detection.
- Returning date/time and comments when changing status.
- Kiosk view for shared screens or reception-style use.
- User profiles with photo, phone, employee ID, job title and manager fields.
- Local authentication, Active Directory/LDAP synchronisation and Microsoft Entra ID sign-in.
- Organisation branding, including logo and primary colour.
- Audit logging for administrative and user activity.
- Daily automatic status reset with per-status exclusions.
- Free use for up to 30 active users, with a paid unlimited-user licence available.

Dashboard example



The screenshot shows the Attendr dashboard interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the Attendr logo, a search bar, and a user profile dropdown showing 'Logged in as Scott Hudson | Logout'. Below the navigation bar is a horizontal menu with departmental filters: All, Executive, Finance, Human Resources, Information Technology, Marketing, Operations, and Sales. The main content area displays a table of staff members with the following columns: Name, Status, Location, Returning, Comments, and Last Updated. The table lists six staff members with their respective status indicators (e.g., 'In Office', 'Sick Leave', 'Work From Home', 'Out of Office', 'Unspecified') and last updated timestamps.

Name	Status	Location	Returning	Comments	Last Updated
SH Scott Hudson	In Office	Head Office	Unspecified	System location update	05/07/2026, 04:13 pm by System
AP Andrew Pemberton	Sick Leave	Unspecified	08/07/2026, 04:20 pm		05/07/2026, 04:20 pm by Scott Hudson
CP Caroline Whittaker	Work From Home	Unspecified	07/07/2026, 07:00 am		05/07/2026, 04:21 pm by Scott Hudson
DS Diane Sutherland	Out of Office	Unspecified	Unspecified		05/07/2026, 04:21 pm by Scott Hudson
MH Margaret Holloway	In Office	Head Office	Unspecified		05/07/2026, 04:22 pm by Scott Hudson
RA Robert Ashford	Unspecified	Unspecified	Unspecified		—

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Figure 1 - Attendr dashboard showing departmental filters, user status, location, return time and last-updated information.

2. System architecture and deployment

Attendr v1.0.1 is delivered as a self-contained Windows package. The bundled Node.js runtime starts an Express web application which serves the browser interface and stores application data locally in SQLite.

Component	Role
Bundled Node.js runtime	Runs the Attendr web application without requiring a separate Node.js installation.
Express application	Hosts the web interface, authentication, administrative pages and API endpoints.
SQLite database	Stores users, settings, departments, locations, statuses, profile data, status history, licences and audit logs.
Session database	Stores web-session data separately in the data directory.
Browser	Users access Attendr using the server address and configured port.
Optional directory integration	LDAP/Active Directory synchronisation and Microsoft Entra ID sign-in can be configured by an administrator.

Default address

When Attendr is running on the local computer, open <http://localhost:3000>. From another computer, use <http://<server-name-or-IP>:3000> unless you have placed Attendr behind a reverse proxy or changed the PORT environment variable.

Application data locations

Path	Purpose	Backup?
data\attendr.db	Primary Attendr SQLite database	Yes - critical
data\attendr.db-wal / .db-shm	SQLite WAL support files while the database is active	Back up with the database after stopping Attendr
data\sessions.db	Web session store	Optional; users can sign in again
app\public\uploads (if present)	Uploaded branding/profile assets	Yes, if used

3. Installation

3.1 Prerequisites

- A supported Windows workstation or server: Windows 10, Windows 11, or Windows Server 2016 or newer.
- A local folder where Attendr can remain installed and write to its data directory.
- TCP port 3000 available by default, or another port supplied through the PORT environment variable.
- Network/firewall access to the Attendr port for any remote users who need to connect.
- A modern web browser on client devices.

No separate Node.js installation required

The Windows package includes its own Node.js runtime and dependencies. Do not replace the bundled runtime unless you are intentionally maintaining a custom build.

3.2 Install Attendr

1. Download Attendr-v1.0.1-Windows.zip from attendr.com.au or the official release location.
2. Extract the complete ZIP archive to the folder where Attendr will run. Do not run directly from inside the ZIP file.
3. Open the extracted Attendr folder.
4. Double-click start.bat.
5. Wait for the console window to show that Attendr is running.
6. Open <http://localhost:3000> in a browser on the server, or browse to the server IP/hostname from another authorised device.

3.3 What start.bat does

The supplied start script changes to the Attendr installation folder, sets the production environment, displays the bundled Node.js version and runtime information, then starts `app\server.js` using `runtime\node.exe`. Keep the console window open while Attendr is running.

4. First-time setup

On a new installation, the root page redirects to the setup wizard until setup has been completed. The wizard creates the organisation settings and the first administrator account.

4.1 Setup wizard fields

Field	Description
Organisation Name	Name displayed by Attendr for the organisation.
Admin Email	Email address used to sign in to the initial administrator account.
Admin Password	Password for the initial administrator account.
Confirm Password	Confirmation of the administrator password.

7. Enter the organisation name.
8. Enter the administrator email address.
9. Create and confirm the administrator password.
10. Submit the setup form.
11. Attendr stores the configuration, creates the initial administrator account and redirects to the login page.
12. Sign in and complete the remaining administration settings before onboarding staff.

Initial administrator account

The first administrator created by setup is treated as a system account and does not consume one of the 30 free active-user seats.

5. Signing in and accounts

5.1 Local sign-in

Local users sign in using their email address and password. Attendr stores passwords as bcrypt hashes rather than plaintext. Users created or reset by an administrator may be required to change their password when they next sign in.

5.2 Account sources

Source	Behaviour
Local	Email/password authentication handled by Attendr.
LDAP / Active Directory	Users can be synchronised from on-premise directory services. Imported users can be forced to set a local Attendr password after first sign-in.
Microsoft Entra ID	When configured, users sign in using the Microsoft sign-in flow. If an eligible Entra user does not yet exist in Attendr, Attendr can create the account automatically, subject to the 30-user free limit or an unlimited licence.

5.3 Session behaviour

The standard Attendr web session is configured for an eight-hour cookie lifetime. Signing out destroys the current server-side session and returns the user to the login page.

6. Using the dashboard

The dashboard is the main in/out board. It displays active users, their latest status, current or selected location, expected return information, comments and last-updated details. Department tabs allow the board to be filtered to a specific group.

6.1 Typical dashboard information

Column / control	Purpose
Name	Staff member name and profile indicator/photo where configured.
Status	Latest active status for the staff member.
Location	Selected or automatically detected location.
Returning	Expected return date/time where supplied.
Comments	Optional context entered with the status update.
Last Updated	Time of latest status change and the user/system that performed the update.
Department tabs	Filters the board by configured department.

6.2 Automatic location detection

An administrator can associate a location with a network CIDR range. When a signed-in user loads or refreshes the dashboard, Attendr can compare the request IP address to configured location networks. If a location is detected, Attendr can use the user's profile preferences to perform a smart automatic status/location update.

Design tip

Use non-overlapping CIDR ranges for office locations. If network address translation, reverse proxies or load balancers are used, validate what client IP Attendr actually receives before relying on automatic location detection.

7. Updating your status

Users update their presence from the dashboard. The status dialog supports a status selection, return-time options, location and a free-text comment.

7.1 Status update fields

Field	Purpose
Status	Select one of the administrator-configured active statuses.
One-Click Return Time	Quick choices for 1 hour, 3 hours, 4 hours or 1 day.
Returning	Set a specific return date/time or use an unknown/unspecified return.
Location	Choose a configured location or Unspecified.
Comment	Optional explanatory text such as appointment, client site or expected availability.

7.2 Status history

Attendr stores status changes as history records. The dashboard displays each user's latest record while retaining previous records in the database for application operation and auditing context.

8. User profiles

Each signed-in user can manage personal profile information and location/status preferences from the Profile page.

Profile setting	Description
Profile photo	Upload or remove a profile image.
Phone	Optional contact number.
Employee ID	Optional internal identifier.
Job title	Optional role/title.
Manager	Optional manager name.
Default location	The user's normal/home Attendr location.
Home status	Status Attendr should prefer when the user is detected at the default location.
Away status	Status Attendr should prefer when the user is detected at another configured location.

Profile preferences and smart updates

Default Location, Home Status and Away Status work with IP-based location detection. Configure all three together for the most predictable automatic behaviour.

9. Kiosk mode

Attendr includes a kiosk page intended for shared displays or reception-style use. The kiosk is available at `/kiosk` and is designed to present staff presence information without requiring the full administrative interface.

Recommended kiosk deployment

- Use a dedicated browser profile or locked-down kiosk device.
- Place the screen where staff presence information is appropriate to display.
- Consider privacy requirements before showing comments, locations or availability in public-facing areas.
- Use a stable server hostname so the kiosk URL does not change when the server IP changes.

10. Administration - users and departments

10.1 User administration

Administrators manage users under Admin > Users. The interface supports creating users, editing user details, assigning roles and departments, resetting passwords and deleting users.

Function	Notes
Add User	Creates a new Attendr user. On the free plan, creation is blocked once 30 active non-system users already exist.
Edit User	Update name, email, role and department membership.
Role	User or Admin. Administrators can access the administration pages.
Reset Password	Forces a new password workflow for the user.
Status preferences	Administrators can set default location, home status and away status when creating users.
Delete User	Removes/deactivates the selected user according to current application behaviour.

10.2 Departments

Departments organise users and provide the dashboard filter tabs. Each department has a name, code and optional description. Users can be assigned to one or more departments.

Free-user limit

The 30-user allowance is based on active non-system users, not the number of departments. Department structure does not affect licensing.

11. Administration - locations and statuses

11.1 Locations

Locations represent offices, campuses, buildings or other places relevant to staff presence. Administrators can create, edit and delete locations and optionally assign a CIDR network to each location for automatic detection.

Field	Example	Purpose
Location Name	Head Office	Friendly display name.
Code	HO	Short internal code.
Address	1 Example Street	Optional physical address.
CIDR	192.168.1.0/24	Network range used for IP-based location detection.

11.2 Statuses

Statuses are fully configurable. Each status has a name, colour, sort order and active state. Attendr ensures that an Out of Office status exists because the daily-reset function uses it as the reset target.

Setting	Purpose
Status Name	Display text shown on dashboard and in update controls.
Sort Order	Controls display order.
Colour	Visual colour used for the status badge.
Exclude from reset	When enabled for a status, users currently in that status are skipped by the daily reset.

12. Branding

Administrators can customise Attendr under Admin > Branding. The current application supports a custom primary brand colour and organisation logo, with reset/remove controls to return to defaults.

Brand colour

The primary colour drives the application theme. Attendr calculates a lighter companion colour server-side so gradients and related UI elements remain consistent across browsers.

Logo

A custom logo can be uploaded and later removed. Keep a copy of the original image outside the Attendr installation so it can be restored after a rebuild or migration.

Backup custom assets

If you use custom branding or user profile images, include the relevant upload directory in your Attendr backup along with the database.

13. Settings and daily reset

13.1 General settings

Admin > Settings displays organisation information, the instance ID, licence status and daily reset controls. The instance ID uniquely identifies the installation for licensing.

13.2 Daily status reset

The daily status reset is enabled by default. At 23:59 local server time, Attendr checks whether the feature is enabled and resets active non-system users to Out of Office. Users whose current status is configured to be excluded from reset are skipped.

Control	Behaviour
Enable daily status reset	Turns the scheduled 23:59 reset on or off.
Manual reset now	Runs the same status-reset logic immediately.
Excluded statuses	Users currently in a status marked Exclude from reset are not changed.
Reset comment	Automatic resets are stored with “Daily automatic reset”; manual resets use “Manual reset”.

Server clock matters

The reset schedule uses the Windows server's local time. Confirm the server time zone and clock are correct, particularly after moving the application to another host.

14. Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID

14.1 Integration page

Admin > Integrations contains configuration for Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) and on-premise LDAP/Active Directory, plus user synchronisation and flagged-user handling.

14.2 Microsoft Entra ID

Setting	Description
Tenant ID	Microsoft Entra tenant identifier.
Client ID	Application/client identifier from the Entra app registration.
Client Secret	Secret value created for the app registration.
Redirect URI	Callback URL for Attendr, typically <code>http(s)://your-server/auth/azure/callback</code> .
Test Connection	Validates the configured Entra connection.

When Entra sign-in is enabled, the login page can offer Microsoft sign-in. If a permitted Entra user signs in and no Attendr user exists for that email address, Attendr can create the account automatically using the configured default role. The free-user limit is checked before auto-creation.

14.3 LDAP / Active Directory

Setting	Description
LDAP Server URL	Directory server address, for example <code>ldap://192.168.1.10</code> .
Port	LDAP service port; the default field value is 389.
Base DN	Directory search base, for example <code>DC=company,DC=local</code> .
Service Account DN	Distinguished name used by Attendr to query the directory.
Service Account Password	Password for the service account.
User Login Attribute	<code>userPrincipalName</code> , <code>sAMAccountName</code> or <code>mail</code> .
Default Role	Role assigned to newly imported users.
Sync OU	Optional OU used to scope synchronisation.
Groups	Optional group names used to scope synchronisation.

14.4 User synchronisation

The integration page can preview/scope directory users, run synchronisation and manage users that Attendr flags when they are no longer present in the synchronisation source. Administrators can keep a flagged user or deactivate flagged users.

Directory security

Use a dedicated read-only service account wherever possible. Protect directory secrets and restrict access to the Attendr server and Admin > Integrations page.

15. Licensing

15.1 Free plan

Attendr v1.0.1 is free forever for up to 30 active non-system users. There is no trial expiry and no write freeze. A licence key is not required within the free allowance.

15.2 Unlimited licence

A paid licence key unlocks unlimited users for the licensed Attendr instance. The key is cryptographically signed and bound to the instance ID shown on Admin > Settings. The current paid licence has no expiry date.

13. Open Admin > Settings and copy the Instance ID.
14. Purchase the Attendr unlimited licence through the official Attendr website.
15. Provide/enter the Instance ID in the licence-generation flow.
16. Copy the generated licence key.
17. Paste the key into Apply licence key under Admin > Settings.
18. Submit the key and confirm the Licence status changes to licensed/unlimited.

15.3 What happens at user 31

When an unlicensed installation already has 30 active non-system users, Attendr blocks creation of additional users. This check also applies to automated account creation through Microsoft Entra ID and directory synchronisation paths that create new users. Existing users continue to use the application.

Instance-bound key

If you build a completely new Attendr instance and it receives a different Instance ID, the licence for the previous instance will not activate on the new instance. Preserve the database when performing a normal migration so the installation identity remains with the instance.

16. Audit logs

Administrators can open Admin > Logs to review recorded activity. Attendr stores the action, entity, target information and the acting user details with a timestamp. The logs page includes search functionality.

Examples of logged events

- Successful and failed logins.
- Logout activity.
- Administrative user changes.
- Automatic account creation through Microsoft Entra ID.
- Actions performed by system processes where applicable.

Operational use

Audit logs are useful for troubleshooting and accountability, but they are stored in the same local application database. Include the database in backups if log history matters to your organisation.

17. Backup, restore and migration

17.1 Recommended backup procedure

19. Schedule a maintenance window if possible.
20. Stop Attendr by closing the running console window or terminating the Attendr process cleanly.
21. Copy the complete data folder to protected backup storage.
22. Copy any uploaded logos/profile images if they are stored outside the database.
23. Record the Attendr version and installation path with the backup.
24. Restart Attendr and confirm users can sign in.

Stop the application first

SQLite uses WAL mode. Stopping Attendr before copying the database is the simplest way to obtain a consistent file-level backup of attendr.db and its companion files.

17.2 Restore

25. Install or extract the same Attendr version on the target Windows host.
26. Ensure Attendr is stopped.
27. Replace the target data folder with the backed-up data folder.
28. Restore uploaded assets if applicable.
29. Start Attendr.
30. Confirm organisation settings, users, statuses, integrations and licence state.
31. Test a status update and login before returning the system to normal use.

17.3 Migration to another Windows host

For a normal host migration, move the application package and preserved data together. Retaining the database preserves the instance ID used by licensing, along with users, configuration and application history. Network/firewall rules and directory-integration callback URLs may need to be updated if the hostname, IP address or URL changes.

18. Security and deployment guidance

Attendr is intended to run on infrastructure controlled by the organisation. The following controls are recommended for a production deployment.

- Run Attendr on a supported and patched Windows host.
- Restrict the Windows account and NTFS permissions on the Attendr installation and data folders.
- Limit inbound firewall access to the networks that require Attendr.
- Use HTTPS through a trusted reverse proxy when users access Attendr across untrusted or shared networks.
- Protect administrator accounts and directory-integration credentials.
- Use a dedicated, least-privilege LDAP service account.
- Back up the database and test restore procedures.
- Do not expose the raw Attendr data directory through a web server or file share.
- Review audit logs and inactive user accounts periodically.
- Treat the instance ID and licence key as administrative information; do not publish them unnecessarily.

Reverse proxy / HTTPS

The application supports proxy awareness and listens on its configured port. If you deploy IIS, Nginx, Apache or another reverse proxy in front of Attendr, terminate TLS at the proxy and forward requests to the local Attendr port. Validate sign-in, Microsoft callback URLs, client-IP detection and kiosk access after proxy changes.

19. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Check
Browser cannot open Attendr	Confirm start.bat is still running, verify the console shows the server listening, then test <code>http://localhost:3000</code> on the server.
Remote users cannot connect	Check Windows Firewall, network ACLs, server IP/hostname and TCP port 3000.
Port already in use	Stop the conflicting service or configure Attendr to use another PORT environment value.
Setup page keeps appearing	Confirm the data folder is writable and that the same installation/data folder is being used on each start.
User cannot sign in	Confirm account email, authentication source and password. Entra accounts must use the Microsoft sign-in button.
New user cannot be added	Check active user count. The free plan stops at 30 active non-system users unless an unlimited licence is active.
Licence key rejected	Check that the key was generated for the Instance ID shown by this Attendr installation.
Automatic location is wrong	Review location CIDR values and what client IP Attendr sees, especially through NAT or a reverse proxy.
Daily reset did not occur	Confirm daily reset is enabled, the server was running at 23:59 local time, and the current status is not excluded from reset.
Directory sync fails	Use Test Connection, verify DNS/network connectivity, credentials, Base DN, OU/group scope and LDAP port.
Microsoft sign-in fails	Verify tenant/client values, client secret, redirect URI and that the Entra application registration matches the Attendr URL.

Diagnostic console

Keep the Attendr console visible while troubleshooting startup problems. The application prints runtime information and server/database errors to the console. Capture the exact error text before restarting or changing configuration.

20. Upgrade and maintenance

Before applying a newer Attendr build, protect the data first. Application upgrades should never rely on the release package as the only copy of your production database.

32. Stop Attendr.
33. Back up the full data folder and uploaded assets.
34. Read the release notes for the target version.
35. Extract the new application build to a separate folder unless the release instructions explicitly require an in-place update.
36. Carry the required production data into the new version according to the release instructions.
37. Start the upgraded instance and allow any application database initialisation/migrations to complete.
38. Test login, dashboard, status changes, administration, integrations and licensing.
39. Keep the previous working version and backup until the new release has been validated.

Routine maintenance checklist

- Confirm backups are completing and can be restored.
- Check free disk space on the Attendr host.
- Keep Windows patched.
- Review administrator accounts and inactive users.
- Review directory secrets before expiry.
- Confirm the server clock/time zone remains correct.
- Review audit logs after significant configuration changes.

21. Quick reference

Item	Value
Local URL	http://localhost:3000
Network URL	http://<server-name-or-IP>:3000
Start command	start.bat
Primary database	data\attendr.db
Session database	data\sessions.db
Admin dashboard	/dashboard
Kiosk	/kiosk
Admin users	/admin/settings/users
Admin locations	/admin/settings/locations
Admin statuses	/admin/settings/statuses
Admin branding	/admin/settings/branding
Admin settings	/admin/settings
Integrations	/admin/integrations
Audit logs	/admin/logs
Free user allowance	30 active non-system users
Paid licence	Unlimited users, instance-bound, no expiry

Recommended go-live checklist

- First administrator account created and tested.
- Organisation name and branding configured.
- Departments, locations and statuses created.
- Location CIDRs validated where automatic detection is used.
- Users added or directory integration tested.
- Daily reset behaviour reviewed and exclusions configured.
- Backup procedure tested.
- Firewall and HTTPS/reverse proxy configuration reviewed.
- Kiosk privacy reviewed if kiosk mode is used.
- Licence state confirmed before onboarding more than 30 active users.

Support

For product information, downloads and licensing, visit <https://attendr.com.au>. When requesting support, include the Attendr version, Windows version, a description of the problem and any relevant console error text. Do not send passwords, client secrets or private keys.



Real-time staff presence. Self-hosted. Simple.

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